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The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2020

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 37)

- #9-11: 1 point for each correct element (separated by +) (max 11)
 - order of phrases does not matter, order within phrases DOES matter
- #16-18: (max 26)
 - 1 point for each correct English sentence element (max 12)
 - 1 point for each correct highlighting (max 3)
 - 1 point for each correct Paiwan sentence element (max 11)
 - insist on complete correctness within each element, e.g. no extra incorrect words (e.g. *who are ...*) and correct function (e.g. re subject/object)
 - accept minor errors unrelated to the data, e.g. *on* for *in*, or *protects* for *protect*, *a~the*, *is eating* for *eats*
 - No marks for focus if more than one element is underlined
 - Credit underlined elements even if the element itself is wrong (e.g. has the wrong function).

9	Paiwan	sitarang + nua uqatay + tua quma + a watu (4)
10	Paiwan	qatupan + nua supulingaw + tua kuqaya-qayam + a gadu nua tsemas (4)
11	Paiwan	djmavis + tua vavuy + a vavaian (3)
16	English	You + protect + the shaman's bird + with <u>the spirit</u> . (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	anema + a kusitarang + tua qaya-qayam + nua pulingaw? (4) OR anema + a kusitarang + nua pulingaw + tua qaya-qayam?
17	English	The man + eats + <u>the pig</u> + in the mountain. (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	anema + a kanen + nua uqatay + i tua gadu? (4) OR anema + a kanen + i tua gadu + nua uqatay?
18	English	I + hunt + your dog + in <u>my field</u> . (4+1 = 5)
	Paiwan	inu + a suqatupan + tua kuvatu? (3)

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Commentary

Paiwan has 4 types of focus in a sentence: Agent Focus (AF), Patient Focus (PF), Referent Focus (RF) and Instrument Focus (IF). Depending on which element of a sentence is focused, the verb conjugates differently.

Agent – subject of transitive verb

Patient – object of transitive verb

Referent – location/time/beneficiary of action

Instrument – instrument/cause/motivation of action

The affixes are:

AF: **-m-** after initial consonant

PF: **-en**

RF: **-an**

IF: **si-**

The article of the noun phrase changes depending on whether it is focused or not:

a = focused element/equational construction marker (CM=)

tua = unfocused non-agent

nua = unfocused agent/genitive construction marker (CMgen)

CM= means that two elements are equal to each other or describe each other.

Another way that you could look at these constructions is that the verbal affixes are derivational morphemes that change the verb into a noun, i.e. **kan** = eat, **k-m-an** = the one who eats, **si-kan** = the thing with which one eats. In this instance, the agent becomes the ‘possessor’ of the new noun and so goes into the genitive case (**nua**).

Both these explanations describe the same data and either would lead to a correct interpretation.

Finally, there are also the prefixes **ku-** and **su-** which refer to the 1st and 2nd person singular respectively. When attached to nouns they indicate possession, and to verbs they indicate agency (although with the derivational theory, the verbs have become nouns anyway).

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 30)

- 2.1. 2 for each correct answer. (max 10)
- 2.2. 1 for each correct word-part (marked here by +). (max 20)
- Insist on correct accents and dotted letters

2.1.a	50	2.2.a	è+ji+lá (3)
b	85	b	àá+do+run (3)
c	75	c	ẹ+ẹtà+dilo+gó+ta (5)
d	103	d	à+rùn+do+gó+ji (5)
e	39	e	òkán+dilo+gó+run (4)

Commentary

Yoruba's counting system is based on 20s, with counting back: the numbers 6,7,8,9 are expressed as 4,3,2,1 before the next ten. 30,50,70,90 are expressed as 10 before the next 20.

In addition, the basic numbers undergo some tone pattern changes.

	Base number	Counting back +dil	Counting forward +d	X20 ogó-
1	<i>not shown</i>	òkán	<i>not shown</i>	ogun * (20)
2	èji	eéjì	èjì	ji (40)
3	èta	eẹ̀tà	ètà	ta (60)
4	èrin	eẹ̀rìn	èrìn	rin (80)
5	àrun	aárùn	àrùn	run (100)
Tone pattern	` -	V' `	` `	ogó -

Teens are expressed by adding lá to the base number. They are not shown here but there *are* base numbers for 6,7,8,9, only used as units. Odd 20s are expressed by àádo '10 off'.

The base form of 1 and the form for counting forward, eg 21, 31, do not follow the same tone pattern, and so are not used here. * Likewise 20 'ogun' is not fully regular. But since 20 is a special value, this is not surprising.

So the given data can be glossed as follows:

èji 2

èrin 4

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àrun	5	
ẹrinlá	14	4 teen
eẹ̀jìdilogun	18	2 before 20
ẹẹ̀rìndilogóji	36	4 before 20x2
ẹ̀rìndogóji	44	4 + 20x2
àádorin	70	10 off 4(score)
ẹẹ̀tádilogórin	77	3 before 20x4
ẹ̀tádogórin	83	3 + 20x4

A1. Write the following Yoruba numbers in figures

a. àádota	50	10 off 3(score)
b. àrúndogórin	85	5 + 4x20
c. aárùndilogórin	75	5 before 4x20
d. ẹ̀tádogórun	103	3 + 5x20
e. òkándilogóji	39	1 before 20x2

Note: òkán has not been seen in the data but if you realise there are only words for 1-5 because of the counting back system, it must be 1: we've seen 2,3,4,5.

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Solution and marking.

Marking (max 34)

- 2 for each correct answer, 1 with one wrong letter
- accept a or ɑ
- accept n for ⁿ
- insist on correct tones
- reject extra words, e.g. *jáng lái* for 14

1	lí-á	7	áo	13	bè-lá-lá á á
2	já	8	nǎo	14	jáng
3	lí-á	9	gù	15	yā
4	lài	10	dráo	16	"ghǎi
5	hì	11	bào	17	"tú-dǐ
6	mào	12	jáng		

Commentary

Pollard Script:

- Consonants are written with large letters, vowels with small diacritics.
- The position of the diacritic around the letter gives the tone: directly above = ˉ, top right = ˊ, right = ˘, bottom left = ˋ.
- Nasalization is marked with the letter C (*n*) before the consonant.
- The components of compounds are written separately.

Miao Grammar:

- Word order is generally SVO, modifiers after modified
- Zero copula
- Tense not explicitly marked—past tense generally assumed
- *tai* and *tu* both used to mark noun phrases

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 32)

- 8.1: 2 points for each correct word; 1 point with one wrong syllable. (max 26)
- Insist on correct accents and underlining or strike-through.
- 8.2: 1 point for each correct sentence-part (subject, verb, object). (max 6)
- Insist on correct tense.

8.1a.	mamachiu 'um <u>u</u> w <u>u</u> kaqhaqa 6
b.	káaqhamit <u>u</u> m <u>u</u> 'um <u>u</u> sarichi 'uway p <u>a</u> qhay 10
c.	tənavəɾəqwamit <u>u</u> m <u>u</u> 'um <u>u</u> tuachi 'uway pə'ətikyaha 10
8.2a.	The drunkards/drinkers/equivalent + kicked + the boy. 3
b	The worker + farmed + the goats. 3

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Commentary

Word order: SOV

Verbs:

Stem+Num+tense

Num: -Q₁a-

Tense:

Past: -Q₂a-

Pres. cont.: -y-

Phonological rules:

Q > qw / ə_

> ky / i_

> qh / a_

Except: aQ₁aQ₂a > aqhaqa

(i.e. -qhaqha forbidden when both are inflectional, but -qhaqha allowed if first qha is in stem, as in 6.)

y > ø / i_

Noun phrases:

Regular nouns (non-nominalized): pl -u

Subject: devoice final vowel unless it is -u

Article¹ follows noun:

Art.	Subj.	Obj.
Sg.	'u	'uway
Pl.	'umu	'umu

Nominalization of verb:

Sg: stem+mitu

Pl: stem+Q₁a+mitu+mu²

¹ Technically no way to determine this is an article so any explanation for it is fine, e.g. syntactic/semantic role marker.

² Explanation: -mi-tu- are a relativizer + nominalizer. -Q₁a- is the normal plural verb marker, -mu is plural marker for some nouns including those derived from verbs. X-Q₁amitumu is therefore "the ones(pl) who do(pl) X" with plural marked twice in the morphology.

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Solution and marking.

Marking (max 22)

- 1 point for each completely correct word. No half marks. (max 22)

a	hiseetewe? or ...owe?	b	oo3	c	coo3o?
d	coo3	e	coo3owe? or ...ewe?	f	hinenin
g	hineninewe? or ...owe?	h	wotooho	i	N/A
j	wo3onohoe	k	N/A	l	nii?eihii
m	nii?eihiiho?	n	nii?eihiihewe? or ...owe?	o	N/A
p	ce?ibexe?	q	benexo	r	N/A
s	benexe?	t	nesi	u	hisio
v	nesihewe?				

Commentary

Semantics

Nouns are classified as animate or inanimate semantically – note, body parts are inanimate, while “pine tree” and “car” are animate (all others are obvious).

Three of the examples (one’s older sister, one’s hand, one’s uncle) are possessed and contain a possessive prefix ne~hi.

Morphology

Stems

Nouns have two “stems”, S1 and S2, related by the following rules for going from S2 → S1:

	S1	←	S2
a.	-V		-Vh, -Vn, or -Vw
b.	-t		-tin
c.	-n		-nin
d.	-3		-t
e.	-x		-3
f.	-s		-x

All rules except (a.) can be performed in either direction. Another way of analysing the changes between S2 and S1 would be to assimilate many of the stem changes into a single

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"chain", as in: s -- x -- 3 -- t -- tin [if S2 ends in any of these, change to S1 by shifting one place to the left, on this chain], each step showing a kind of softening or reduction. The same reduction process would extend beyond the chain to Vh/n/w > V and nin > n. This process is similar to the 'soft mutation' of Welsh.

Inflectional rules

	singular	plural	obv. sing	loc sing
animate	S1	S2+o?	S1+o if S2= -h otherwise S2	S2+Vwe? V = o/e if stem contains o/e
inanimate	S1	S2+o	N/A	S2+e?

Note the limited vowel harmony in the locative singular. Note that this rule can be described, consistently with the data, in several consistent ways, including:

- if root contains e, then V = e
- else V = o

*Alternative solution: consistently with the data, this pattern can be explained as:

- V = e (for humans)
- V = o (for non-humans)

This alternate solution is not an actual rule in Arapaho, but since it fits the data given, it was scored identically, in both parts (R1 and R2), to the vowel harmony solution.

Possessive prefixes

The prefix "ne-" indicates possession (in English, "*my ..."). In the obviative singular, when this form exists (i.e., for animate nouns):

- ne- → hi-

(One way of explaining why this change happens is that the grammatical person is different in the obviative.)